

PLATO AND ARISTOTLE

DIALOGUE-CONTROLLED FORMS → PARTICIPATION AND CAUSAL PRESSURE → CONTEXT-SENSITIVE SUBSTANCE → HYLOMORPHISM → CHANGE/CAUSES → POTENCY/ACT

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g6 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 CENTRAL PROBLEM: ONE, MANY, KNOWLEDGE AND STABILITY

CENTRAL PROBLEM ONE, MANY, KNOWLEDGE AND STABILITY HOW CAN MANY CHANGING THINGS SHARE ONE KNOWABLE CHARACTER? MANY JUST ACTS ONE INTELLIGIBLE STANDARD OF JUSTICE EPISTEME REQUIRES A STABLE OBJECT, NOT FLUX ALONE
TRANSCENDENT FORMS; PARTICULARS PARTICIPATE OR IMITATE SEPARATION MAKES THE FORM-PARTICULAR RELATION HARD TO EXPLAIN

CENTRAL QUESTION: HOW CAN MANY CHANGING THINGS SHARE ONE KNOWABLE CHARACTER?

ONE-MANY: many just acts → one intelligible standard of Justice

KNOWLEDGE: episteme requires a stable object, not flux alone

PLATO: transcendent Forms; particulars participate or imitate

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- CENTRAL QUESTION: HOW CAN MANY CHANGING THINGS SHARE ONE KNOWABLE CHARACTER?
- ONE-MANY: many just acts → one intelligible standard of Justice

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- KNOWLEDGE: episteme requires a stable object, not flux alone
- PLATO: transcendent Forms; particulars participate or imitate

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- COST: separation makes the Form-particular relation hard to explain
- CENTRAL QUESTION: HOW CAN MANY CHANGING THINGS SHARE ONE KNOWABLE CHARACTER?

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Many changing particulars are intelligible as instances only because a stable universal Form supplies the common character reason grasps.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Plato's standard middle-dialogue Forms answer one-many and knowledge problems, but each claim must remain tied to its dialogue and the cost of separation.

01

STAGE 01 TWO-LEVEL ONTOLOGY AND THE ASCENT FROM OPINION TO KNOWLEDGE

TWO-LEVEL ONTOLOGY AND THE ASCENT FROM OPINION TO KNOWLEDGE PLATO'S TWO-LEVEL ONTOLOGY STABLE, UNIVERSAL MANY, CHANGING EPISTEME THROUGH REASON DOXA THROUGH PERCEPTION ^ PARTICIPATION VISIBLE THINGS THE GOOD GROUNDS BOTH BEING AND KNOWABILITY.

PLATO'S TWO-LEVEL ONTOLOGY

Forms: stable, universal

particulars: many, changing episteme through reason

doxa through perception

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- PLATO'S TWO-LEVEL ONTOLOGY
- Forms: stable, universal
- particulars: many, changing episteme through reason

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- doxa through perception
- ^ participation / imitation
- CAVE: shadows → visible things → mathematics → Forms → Good

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- LINE: eikasia → pistis → dianoia → noesis
- SUN: the Good grounds both being and knowability.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Cognitive ascent occurs by leaving images and unexamined hypotheses for dialectical understanding of Forms under the illumination of the Good.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Sun, Line and Cave jointly identify the Good as the condition of being and knowing, grade opinion into knowledge, and portray education as the turning of the soul toward intelligible reality.

02

STAGE 02 PARTICIPATION PRESSURE AND ARISTOTLE'S IMMANENT REPAIR

PARTICIPATION PRESSURE AND ARISTOTLE'S IMMANENT REPAIR PLATONIC EXPLANATION ARISTOTELIAN PRESSURE FORM F MANY F-THINGS PARTICIPATION REMAINS METAPHORICAL SEPARATE PARADIGM EXPLAINS COMMON F SEPARATION DUPLICATES THE EXPLANANDUM
LIKENESS INVITES ANOTHER FORM THIRD MAN

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- PLATONIC EXPLANATION ARISTOTELIAN PRESSURE
- Form F → participation → many F-things
- participation remains metaphorical separate paradigm explains common F

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- separation duplicates the explanandum
- likeness invites another Form
- THIRD MAN: particulars + Form F resemble → further Form F2 → regress

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- REPLY: deny unrestricted self-predication or restrict the premise
- RESIDUAL: how does a separate Form causally determine a particular?
- ARISTOTLE'S REPAIR: retain form, but make it immanent in concrete substance.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Participation and likeness invite regress; Plato's Good and Timaeus cosmology add explanatory resources, but separated Forms still do not internalise change.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Aristotle's criticism does not deny intelligibility through form; it denies that a separately existing Form can explain particulars without duplication, a non-metaphorical participation relation and regress.

02

PARTICIPATION PRESSURE AND ARISTOTLE'S IMMANENT REPAIR

PLATONIC EXPLANATION ARISTOTELIAN PRESSURE

FORM F

MANY F-THINGS

PARTICIPATION REMAINS METAPHORICAL SEPARATE PARADIGM EXPLAINS COMMON F

SEPARATION DUPLICATES THE EXPLANANDUM

LIKENESS INVITES ANOTHER FORM

THIRD MAN

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

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MECHANISM / VERDICT

Participation and likeness invite regress; Plato's Good and Timaeus cosmology add explanatory resources, but separated Forms still do not internalise change.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Aristotle's criticism does not deny intelligibility through form; it denies that a separately existing Form can explain particulars without duplication, a non-metaphorical participation relation and regress.

03

STAGE 03

ARISTOTLE'S SUBSTANCE HIERARCHY AND EXPLANATORY ESSENCE

ARISTOTLE'S SUBSTANCE HIERARCHY AND EXPLANATORY ESSENCE

WHAT EXISTS PRIMARILY, AND WHAT MAKES IT WHAT IT IS

WHICH THINGS? METAPHYSICS

THIS PERSON/HORSE FORM OR ESSENCE EXPLAINS THE COMPOUND SECONDARY

SPECIES AND GENUS MATTER ALONE IS NOT A DETERMINATE

SAFE SYNTHESIS

INDIVIDUAL EXISTS; FORM EXPLAINS ITS IDENTITY

CATEGORIES: WHICH THINGS? METAPHYSICS: SUBSTANCE-HOOD?

→

primary = this person/horse form or essence explains the compound secondary = species and genus

→

not a determinate this accidents exist in a substance universal and genus are not primary

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ARISTOTLE: WHAT EXISTS PRIMARILY, AND WHAT MAKES IT WHAT IT IS?
- CATEGORIES: WHICH THINGS? METAPHYSICS: SUBSTANCE-HOOD?

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- primary = this person/horse form or essence explains the compound secondary = species and genus matter alone is
- not a determinate this accidents exist in a substance universal and genus are not primary

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- safe synthesis: individual exists; form explains its identity
- ARISTOTLE: WHAT EXISTS PRIMARILY, AND WHAT MAKES IT WHAT IT IS?

MECHANISM / VERDICT

The individual bears predicates, while its form or essence answers why this matter constitutes this determinate substance.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Aristotle makes the concrete individual the primary subject of predication, yet explains substance-hood through immanent form and essence, thereby distinguishing what exists primarily from what makes it what it is.

04

STAGE 04

HYLOMORPHIC COMPOSITE: MATTER, FORM AND SUBSTANTIAL UNITY

HYLOMORPHIC COMPOSITE

MATTER, FORM AND SUBSTANTIAL UNITY

ONE NATURAL SUBSTANCE

MATTER INFORMED BY IMMANENT FORM

FORM THAT OUT OF WHICH

ESSENCE RELATIVE POTENTIALITY

ACTUALITY CAN RECEIVE DETERMINATION

MAKES THE COMPOSITE ONE

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ONE NATURAL SUBSTANCE = MATTER INFORMED BY IMMANENT FORM
- FORM that out of which
- what-it-is / essence relative potentiality

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- organisation / actuality can receive determination
- makes the composite one
- CONCRETE COMPOSITE bronze + statue-form; wood + table-form; body + soul in a living organism

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- LIMIT: prime matter is a theoretical limit, not independently existing stuff.

MECHANISM / VERDICT

Matter makes alternative determination possible, while form organises that capacity into the actual unity and intelligibility of a substance.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Hylomorphism applies to sensible substances: matter and form are correlative principles, not independently existing components, and substantial change needs privation.

05

STAGE 05

FOUR CAUSES AS A MATRIX OF EXPLANATORY COMPLETENESS

FOUR CAUSES AS A MATRIX OF EXPLANATORY COMPLETENESS

ONE QUESTION, FOUR COMPLEMENTARY SENSES OF WHY

FINAL MADE OF WHAT

WHAT IT IS

SOURCE OF CHANGE

FOR THE SAKE OF WHAT WOOD

TABLE STRUCTURE

CARPENTER AND TOOLS

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
ONE QUESTION, FOUR COMPLEMENTARY SENSES OF WHY	for the sake of what wood	NATURAL CASE: acorn matter + oak form + generating parent/process + mature oak telos
FINAL made of what	table structure	formal, efficient and final causes may coincide in natural development
what it is	carpenter and tools	teleology need not mean a conscious external designer
source of change	usable working surface	RESULT: explanatory completeness is richer than efficient succession alone.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- ONE QUESTION, FOUR COMPLEMENTARY SENSES OF WHY
- FINAL made of what
- what it is
- source of change

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- for the sake of what wood
- table structure
- carpenter and tools
- usable working surface

EVALUATION / TRAP

- NATURAL CASE: acorn matter + oak form + generating parent/process + mature oak telos
- formal, efficient and final causes may coincide in natural development
- teleology need not mean a conscious external designer
- RESULT: explanatory completeness is richer than efficient succession alone.

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05

STAGE 05

FOUR CAUSES AS A MATRIX OF EXPLANATORY COMPLETENESS

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SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
ONE QUESTION, FOUR COMPLEMENTARY SENSES OF WHY	for the sake of what wood	NATURAL CASE: acorn matter + oak form + generating parent/process + mature oak telos
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SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

ONE QUESTION, FOUR COMPLEMENTARY SENSES OF WHY

FINAL made of what

what it is

source of change

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

for the sake of what wood

table structure

carpenter and tools

usable working surface

EVALUATION / TRAP

NATURAL CASE: acorn matter + oak form + generating parent/process + mature oak telos

formal, efficient and final causes may coincide in natural development

teleology need not mean a conscious external designer

RESULT: explanatory completeness is richer than efficient succession alone.

MECHANISM / VERDICT

Matter, form and privation structure change; the four causes explain how a determinate potential becomes an actuality whose form supplies identity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Aristotle's four causes are complementary dimensions of explanatory completeness, because material constitution, formal identity, efficient production and final end answer irreducible senses of why.

06

STAGE 06

POTENTIALITY TO ACTUALITY: CHANGE WITHOUT CREATION FROM NOTHING

POTENTIALITY TO ACTUALITYCHANGE WITHOUT CREATION FROM NOTHINGGROUNDED CAPACITYPROCESS OF ACTUALISATIONFULFILLED ACTUALITY WOOD FIT FOR A TABLECUTTING AND JOININGCOMPLETED TABLE ACORN ORDERED TO OAKORGANIC DEVELOPMENT

GROUNDED CAPACITY → PROCESS OF ACTUALISATION → FULFILLED ACTUALITY wood fit for a table →

→ completed table acorn ordered to oak → organic development
→ mature oak dynamis kinesis

→ change = actuality of the potential precisely as potential

→ actuality is prior in definition, end and species-level explanation

→ qualification: potentiality may be earlier in an individual's time

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

GROUNDED CAPACITY → PROCESS OF ACTUALISATION → FULFILLED ACTUALITY wood fit for a table → cutting and joining

→ completed table acorn ordered to oak → organic development → mature oak dynamis kinesis energeia / entelecheia

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

change = actuality of the potential precisely as potential

actuality is prior in definition, end and species-level explanation

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

qualification: potentiality may be earlier in an individual's time

RESULT: becoming is structured being-in-capacity, not emergence from sheer non-being.

MECHANISM / VERDICT

An efficient process actualises a grounded capacity under a determining form and toward the completed actuality that gives the process direction.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Potentiality is a real, qualified capacity ordered to actuality, so change becomes the actualisation of what can be rather than an impossible leap from non-being to being.

07

STAGE 07

TELEOLOGICAL ORDER AND PURE ACTUALITY

TELEOLOGICAL ORDER AND PURE ACTUALITYMOTION HERE AND NOW REQUIRES ACTUALITY, BUT THE SERIESMOVED MOVERORDERED ETERNAL MOTIONUNMOVED MOVERPURE ACTUALITY WITHOUT UNREALISED POTENTIALITYMOVES AS FINAL CAUSEOBJECT OF DESIRE AND THOUGHT

MOTION HERE AND NOW REQUIRES ACTUALITY, BUT THE SERIES CANNOT BE PURE POTENCY moved mover

→ UNMOVED MOVER = PURE ACTUALITY WITHOUT UNREALISED POTENTIALITY

→ moves as final cause: object of desire and thought

→ thought thinking itself; no material composition

→ not a temporal first event or material cause

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

MOTION HERE AND NOW REQUIRES ACTUALITY, BUT THE SERIES CANNOT BE PURE POTENCY moved mover → moved mover → ordered eternal motion

UNMOVED MOVER = PURE ACTUALITY WITHOUT UNREALISED POTENTIALITY

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

moves as final cause: object of desire and thought

thought thinking itself; no material composition

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

not a temporal first event or material cause

LIMIT: do not equate Aristotle's mover with a personal efficient creator.

MECHANISM / VERDICT

The highest actuality moves without undergoing change because dependent motion is ordered toward it as the ultimate object of desire and thought.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Unmoved Mover completes Aristotle's priority of actuality as pure act and final cause of cosmic motion, but it should not be assimilated uncritically to a personal efficient creator.

08

STAGE 08

PLATO AND ARISTOTLE ON FORM: COMPARISON, CRITICISM AND REPLY

PLATO AND ARISTOTLE ON FORMCOMPARISON, CRITICISM AND REPLYARISTOTLE STATUS OF FORMTRANSCENDENT AND SEPARATEIMMANENT IN SUBSTANCE PRIMARY REALITYUNIVERSAL FORMCONCRETE INDIVIDUAL RELATION TO PARTICULARSHYLOMORPHIC CONSTITUTION EXPLANATION OF CHANGE

DOCTRINE / CLAIM	OBJECTION / PRESSURE	REPLY / RESIDUAL
ARISTOTLE status of form	participation / imitation	REPLY FOR PLATO → stable universals secure objectivity, definition and norms
transcendent and separate	hylomorphic constitution explanation of change	OBJECTION TO ARISTOTLE → universality and prime matter remain difficult

08

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The highest actuality moves without undergoing change because dependent motion is ordered toward it as the ultimate object of desire and thought.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Unmoved Mover completes Aristotle's priority of actuality as pure act and final cause of cosmic motion, but it should not be assimilated uncritically to a personal efficient creator.

STAGE 08

PLATO AND ARISTOTLE ON FORM: COMPARISON, CRITICISM AND REPLY

PLATO AND ARISTOTLE ON FORM

COMPARISON, CRITICISM AND REPLY

ARISTOTLE STATUS OF FORM

TRANSCENDENT AND SEPARATE

IMMANENT IN SUBSTANCE PRIMARY REALITY

UNIVERSAL FORM

CONCRETE INDIVIDUAL RELATION TO PARTICULARS

HYLOMORPHIC CONSTITUTION EXPLANATION OF CHANGE

DOCTRINE / CLAIM	OBJECTION / PRESSURE	REPLY / RESIDUAL
ARISTOTLE status of form	participation / imitation	REPLY FOR PLATO → stable universals secure objectivity, definition and norms
transcendent and separate	hylomorphic constitution explanation of change	OBJECTION TO ARISTOTLE → universality and prime matter remain difficult
immanent in substance primary reality	limited paradigmatic role	VERDICT → Aristotle transforms Plato's insight; he does not simply erase it.
universal Form	causes plus potency-act	

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

• ARISTOTLE status of form

• transcendent and separate

• immanent in substance primary reality

• universal Form

• concrete individual relation to particulars

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

• participation / imitation

• hylomorphic constitution explanation of change

• limited paradigmatic role

• causes plus potency-act

• OBJECTION TO PLATO → duplication, regress and causal gap

REPLY / RESIDUAL

• REPLY FOR PLATO → stable universals secure objectivity, definition and norms

• OBJECTION TO ARISTOTLE → universality and prime matter remain difficult

• VERDICT → Aristotle transforms Plato's insight; he does not simply erase it.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Aristotle preserves Plato's demand for intelligible form but relocates its explanatory work inside substances, causes and developmental powers.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Plato secures universality by transcendent Forms, whereas Aristotle internalises form within substance to gain causal and developmental explanation, though both must still account for the relation between universality and particulars.

09

STAGE 09

ANSWER SPINE AND PRECISION DISTINCTIONS

ANSWER SPINE AND PRECISION DISTINCTIONS

ORGANISING ACTUALITY; UNIVERSAL

PREDICABLE OF MANY

WHAT-IT-IS; SUBSTANCE

PRIMARY BEARER

CONCRETE BEING

CAPACITY PRINCIPLE; CAUSE

EXPLANATORY BECAUSE

DIRECTIVE → DEFINITION → ARGUMENT → EXAMPLE → OBJECTION → REPLY → VERDICT

→

FORM: organising actuality; UNIVERSAL: predicable of many

→

ESSENCE: what-it-is; SUBSTANCE: primary bearer / concrete being

→

MATTER: capacity principle; CAUSE: explanatory because

→

POTENTIALITY: qualified capacity; ACTUALITY: fulfilment or activity

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

• DIRECTIVE → DEFINITION → ARGUMENT → EXAMPLE → OBJECTION → REPLY → VERDICT

• FORM: organising actuality; UNIVERSAL: predicable of many

• ESSENCE: what-it-is; SUBSTANCE: primary bearer / concrete being

• MATTER: capacity principle; CAUSE: explanatory because

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

• POTENTIALITY: qualified capacity; ACTUALITY: fulfilment or activity

• PYQ ROUTES

• Forms → one-many + knowledge + participation; Substance → Categories/Metaphysics

• Causes → four complementary explanations; Change → potentiality to actuality

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

• Comparison → transcendent Form versus immanent form on matched axes

• FINAL CONTROL: answer the printed directive, not a general biography of two thinkers.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Directive fidelity converts doctrine into marks by ordering definition, argument, named example, criticism, reply and an explicitly qualified verdict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Answer only the printed metaphysics and routed PYQ: use dialogue/work context, then definition, argument, example, objection, reply and qualified verdict.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

ADVANCED SESSION 1 — PLATO'S MASTER MAP

FORMS, PARTICULARS AND TWO-WORLD ONTOLOGY

ADVANCED SESSION 2 — SUN, DIVIDED LINE AND CAVE

GOOD, KNOWLEDGE AND METAPHYSICS

ADVANCED SESSION 3 — PARTICIPATION, THIRD MAN AND ARISTOTLE'S

ADVANCED SESSION 4 — ARISTOTLE'S SUBSTANCE

CATEGORIES, METAPHYSICS AND ACCIDENTS

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

• ADVANCED SESSION 1 — Plato's Master Map: Forms, Particulars and Two-World Ontology

• ADVANCED SESSION 2 — Sun, Divided Line and Cave: Good, Knowledge and Metaphysics

• ADVANCED SESSION 3 — Participation, Third Man and Aristotle's Critique of Separated Forms

• ADVANCED SESSION 4 — Aristotle's Substance: Categories, Metaphysics and Accidents

ADVANCED OBJECTION

• ADVANCED SESSION 5 — Hylomorphism: Matter Relativity, Prime Matter and the Status of Form

• ADVANCED SESSION 6 — Four Causes and Teleology: Artifacts, Organisms and Development

• ADVANCED SESSION 7 — Potentiality and Actuality: Energeia, Entelecheia and Becoming

• ADVANCED SESSION 8 — The Unmoved Mover and Aristotle's Integrated Metaphysical System

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

• ADVANCED SESSION 9 — Plato-Aristotle Comparison, Criticisms and Wider Philosophical Debates

• ADVANCED SESSION 10 — PYQ Routing, Terminology, Directives, Citations and Verdict Discipline

• ADVANCED DOSSIER REFINEMENTS — USE SELECTIVELY

• Elucidate: clarify implications and distinctions.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels

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